My job was given to a young teacher, and the station asked me to help break him in. While I was doing it, I mentioned how I'd been hired and then fired. When he heard the story, he demanded a contract from WOC that would provide him with job security; he didn't want to give up the relative security of teaching and then wind up in the same fix as I. But WOC didn't give contracts to *anyone* and turned him down. He quit the next day and the station manager asked me to stay until they could find someone else.

I agreed to stay on one condition: They had to assign someone to help me improve my on-the-air delivery.

Pete and other friends went to work on me and gave me a crash course on radio announcing, and I began reading over the commercials before airtime and practicing my delivery to get the right rhythm and cadence and give my words more emotion. Whatever I did during those few days worked: After another week or two, the talk at WOC about replacing me stopped.

Then, enter another break for Dutch Reagan.

I'd been in Davenport less than three months when Pete called me to his office and asked: "Do you know anything about track?"

I said, "Hell, yes, I ran the quarter mile and was on a championship relay team."

WHO, our sister station in Des Moines, he said, needed someone to broadcast the Drake Relays, one of the top track meets in the country. I got the assignment.

A few weeks later, the Palmer Company received a permit for a 50,000-watt clear channel station in Des Moines. We were told WOC was closing and all of us were going to WHO.

Until then, both stations had operated only low-power 1,000-watt transmitters with limited range. There were only fifteen 50,000-watt clear channel stations in America at the time and to work at one was the biggest thing in radio.